

Commission credibility on the line

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【要点】

- ・ロビイスト連合がEU委員会に対し、ブレグジット後の通商協定における地域産業部品要件の規制を堅持するよう求めており、委員長宛の書簡をPOLITICOが入手した。
- ・EU-英国通商協力協定により、電気自動車は55%以上、バッテリーパックは70%以上の地域産業部品を含む必要があり、基準を満たさない車両には10%の関税が課される。
- ・自動車業界が規制の再延期を要求しているが、連合はこれに応じるとEU委員会の信頼性が損なわれ、より広範な産業加速法の実施における説得力も失われると警告している。
- ・地域産業政策に基づく需要創出ルールが機能しなければ、欧州の産業政策が真摯に受け止められず、新規工場建設への投資判断に影響すると指摘されている。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By TOMMASO LECCA with JORDYN DAHL and MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — A coalition of

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

By TOMMASO LECCA

with JORDYN DAHL and MARTINA SAPIO

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SNEAK PEEK

— A coalition of lobbyists is urging the Commission to hold the line on upcoming local content requirements under the Brexit trade agreement.

—Europe's next transport investment wave will need more than EU grants — national budgets, EIB lending and private capital will all have to play a bigger role.

— The ability of European aviation to maintain its edge over global competitors was a top concern during Connecting Europe Days.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

EXCLUSIVE — COMMISSION'S CREDIBILITY ON LOCAL CONTENT IS AT STAKE: That's the message from a coalition of lobbying groups in a letter sent to Commission President Ursula von der Leyen today

and obtained in advance by POLITICO . They're referring to the EU-U.K. Trade and Cooperation Agreement — setting post-Brexit trade ties — whose next phase is set to go into effect in January.

Catch up: Under the TCA, a vehicle with a large enough share of parts coming from the EU or the U.K. — at least 55% of an electric vehicle, at least 70% of the battery pack and 65% of a battery's cells — can cross the Channel tariff-free. Any vehicle that doesn't meet the local content requirements will face a 10% duty.

Pausing under pressure: In December 2023, the EU and the U.K. exceptionally granted a postponement of the rules for three years to give the car sector more time to adapt. At the time, they underlined : "No further postponement of the incoming rules should be considered." But now the car industry is pushing for another pause.

A mistake: The coalition — chemicals lobby CEFIC, green NGO Transport & Environment and European Metals — argue in the letter that the TCA acts as a "miniature" Industrial Accelerator Act with "similar demand-side logic." If the Commission bends to the automotive sector's demands to again delay local content requirements, the letter says, it will put the executive's credibility into question when it comes to implementing the far broader IAA.

Not buying it: Any decision to delay enforcing the rules would affect more than just the TCA, the coalition writes. "This is the litmus test for whether Europe's industrial policy is to be taken seriously." The EU will struggle to convince investors that its Buy European rules under the IAA will be enforced and that it makes sense to open new factories in the bloc "if rules underpinning demand disappear just as they begin to bite," the letter reads.

Carmakers' warning: EU car lobby ACEA sent its own letter to the Commission earlier this month, saying the rules-of-origin requirements would cost the sector €1.47 billion in 2027. The U.K. will export around 520,000 electric vehicles to the EU next year, the group says, but 82% of them would not meet the local content requirements and would face the 10% duty.

What they want: "To avoid the catastrophic effect of widespread noncompliance, ACEA proposes a time limited change to the rules for batteries," the lobby wrote. More specifically, it wants a "flexible rule" for battery pack assembly in place until 2029, with the rule becoming "significantly more restrictive" in 2030 and only go fully into effect in 2032.

CARS

CHINA SHOCK IS HERE: Europe is "on a trajectory to lose" its industrial future to China, a new report from Chatham House warns. The closure of production sites for automakers and machine tool manufacturers is "an ominous sign for the long-term viability of entire European strategic industries," it states. The report includes electric vehicles as one of the four sectors hit hardest by China's lead.

TRANSPORT BUDGET

EIB LOOKS BEYOND BRUSSELS FOR TRANSPORT CASH: Europe's next wave of transport investment will have to rely on a much broader financing mix than EU grants alone, EIB Vice President Robert de Groot told Martina. He pointed to national infrastructure budgets, EIB lending and private capital — including pension funds — alongside the Connecting Europe Facility as options, but added that projects still must be prepared, prioritized and brought forward by member countries.

Private money craze: De Groot said public-private partnerships, which had lost some popularity after their heyday a decade ago, are attracting interest again. He sees room for them in infrastructure with a clear commercial purpose, including ports and other transport assets, especially where public budgets alone are unlikely to cover the scale of investment needed.

We can help: Once governments decide what they want to build, de Groot said the bank can step in early with technical expertise. The EIB already finances roads and railways across Europe and has teams of engineers, economists and other specialists who can help turn national plans into viable projects.

Airports back in the conversation: Asked whether security needs and decarbonization could reopen the door to more public support for airports, de Groot pushed back on the idea that the EIB had ever really left the sector. He said the bank has continued financing sustainable aviation fuels, airport greening and electric aviation, and is also open to helping airports finance defensive measures.

Standardization matters too: De Groot argued that Europe also needs more common standards, particularly at border crossings, where physical infrastructure, IT and regulation can differ from country to country. "Let's try and come to one IT system and not 10," he said, backing a more standardized model that could be replicated across Europe.

Think in corridors: De Groot highlighted several cross-border axes where national investments will only work if they connect: the route from northern Greece through Bulgaria and Romania; the northern links from Norway through Sweden, and Finland toward Poland and the Baltics; and west-east corridors running from major western ports. The implication is that financing one section in isolation does little if neighboring countries do not follow.

Germany is the hinge: He singled out Germany as especially important because so many European transport axes run through it. Berlin is still working through its infrastructure investment plans, he said, but once those decisions are taken, countries including Poland, the Netherlands, Belgium and France will need to line up their own spending accordingly.

The financing challenge: De Groot's broader argument is that Europe does not necessarily need one giant new transport pot. The bigger task is to combine EU money, national budgets, EIB finance and private capital more effectively — and then make sure countries are investing in pieces of the same network rather than in disconnected national projects.

AVIATION

FUTURE OF EUROPEAN AVIATION COMPETITIVENESS WORRIES THE INDUSTRY: European aviation's capacity to maintain its edge over global competitors emerged as a top concern for the sector during the Connecting Europe Days. A panel focusing on the future of aviation on Wednesday pinpointed the main issues.

Too slow on innovation: Manufacturers, airlines and innovation bodies warned the Commission that the EU's leadership in aviation cannot be taken for granted and that the bloc needs to move faster in several areas, including R&D. "Sometimes it takes 10 years to upgrade an air traffic management system," said Andreas Boschen, executive director of the SESAR Joint Undertaking, a public-private partnership working on the digitalization of the Single European Sky.

"This is not any longer possible in the world we are living in," Boschen added, pointing to the U.S. government's plan — yet to be passed by Congress — to invest \$30 billion to modernize its air traffic

control system. The need to accelerate the process from research to deployment of new technologies was also stressed by representatives of the EU Aviation Safety Agency and the Clean Aviation Joint Undertaking during the debate.

Industry headaches: "There's a big problem with supply chains," said Klara Wittkowski, EU representative of Airbus. She pointed to delays in delivering planes as an ongoing issue. "We're still working very hard to make sure that we can actually build and deliver our aircraft to our customers in the time ... we have agreed with them and meet the market demand," which she said is going to double in the next 20 years.

Beware the budget: Wittkowski urged the Commission to include programs supporting clean tech, from less-polluting engines to hydrogen aircraft, in the bloc's next long-term budget, currently under discussion.

Profits down: IATA's Thomas Reynaert warned that, despite air traffic growth, airlines' average profit could fall to \$6-7 per passenger from the \$10 registered "in the best years" and predicted "serious issues" if the cost of doing business in Europe continues to grow. Reynaert mentioned high fuel prices as the first driver of costs but criticized Brussels for making the situation worse through its regulatory burden.

Sustainable aviation fuel mandates, in particular, "are not realistic," Reynaert said. He described synthetic fuel, or e-SAF, as being "at an experimental level" and called for a "reality check" on the targets. "We don't want to be punished if it's not available," he added, referring to SAFs.

PIT STOPS

From us : Volkswagen told its workers union that the German automaker will terminate multiple collective agreements, setting the stage for a battle between the two.

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Passengers and crew members entered the cockpit and overpowered the attacker, according to officials.

By Ashley Ahn · Oct 01, 2026, 01:27 am Europe/Brussels CEST

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By Jules Darmanin · Sept 30, 2026, 04:20 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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By Gabriel Gavin, Camille Gijs · Sept 30, 2026, 03:00 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Document: EU negotiators make headway on military mobility's emergency mechanism

By Martina Sapio · Sept 30, 2026, 02:05 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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By Camille Gijs · Sept 30, 2026, 11:59 am Europe/Brussels CEST

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